

British East Asia Cabinet Legislative Act

Sponsors: Sir Arthur Harold Dickinson, Rear-Admiral Ernest John Spooner, Sir John Bagnall, Lt Gen Lewis Heath, Maj Gen Gordon Bennett

Signatories: Dr Thomas Cooper, Vice Air Marshal Conway

The British East Asia Cabinet,

Recognising the increased amount of espionage coming from the People's Defence Cabinet and the Dalforce,

Deeply concerned over domestic instabilities which so hinder our ability to hold the line against the Japanese tide,

Condemning the ineffectiveness of the civilian government to maintain order and stability in Singapore,

Further condemning their repeated criticism of the British Cabinet, which is highly detrimental to overall morale and cohesion,

Hereby,

ARTICLE I: Declaration of Martial Law by the British East Asia Cabinet

1. Declares a period of martial law for 12 months, or until the Japanese Empire has been pushed back to Penang, whichever comes first:
 - a. Wherein the civilian government, its following powers and duties shall be assigned to a select committee of British East Asia Cabinet members:
 - i. The power to pass civilian laws and directives over the civilian governance of Singapore;
 - ii. The power to declare curfews and other controls on movements;
 - iii. The power to requisition civilian items, metal and property for the defence of Singapore;
 - iv. The power to pass judgment and hold trial over those who have committed crimes;
 - v. The power to dissolve judiciary bodies and replace them with military tribunals for all matters relating to the security of the state;
 - vi. The duty of protecting Singapore and upholding its domestic stability;
 - vii. The power to change ration amounts;

- viii. The power to arrest and detain without trial those who wish to violate any authority or authoritarian actions as passed by the select committee;
 - ix. Any other power normally accorded to the local and civilian government, which the select committee deems necessary to requisition for the defence of Singapore;
- b. The select committee consisting of the greatest portfolios of the Cabinet: Major General Gordon Bennett, Lieutenant General Lewis Heath, Rear-Admiral E. J. Spooner, Sir Arthur Harold Dickinson and Dr Thomas Cooper shall preside over the governing matters of Singapore in addition to their current military or otherwise responsibilities, they shall have the power to pass or veto any legislative bill through a majority vote within the select committee following the input of the wider British East Asia Cabinet.